

Radical Choices and Emotional Literacy

Individuals all have an inherent emotional intelligence (EQ). Emotional Literacy is the ability and commitment to be self-aware, and, as a result, to make decisions and behave in alignment with an individual's objectives and vision. People who achieve this ability can accomplish business and personal relationship goals with ease and unimagined success. Radical Choices teaches people to apply this skill to their everyday decisions and behaviors through our emotional literacy learning process.

Studies now substantiate that an individual's success is more dependent upon "Emotional IQ" than intellectual intelligence. Emotional literacy is a transferable skill. Radical Choices has developed a learning technology that facilitates the learning of emotional literacy. Training programs designed and delivered within the context of emotional literacy provide deeper, longer-term learning and facilitate real behavior change.

What Is Emotional Literacy?

Throughout our lives, there are many events that we want to leave behind, so we often cloud them up or create pleasant illusions to cover up the pain. When we do this we then forget in our conscious minds what happened. However, when experiences are interpreted and changed and the feelings are diluted and dulled, the experience doesn't go away. They build up power and begin to control our behavior, albeit unconsciously.

We develop our patterns of clouding over painful emotions, patterns of interpretation and protection, in our childhood. Because of this, many of us have no idea what and when we're feeling. We are really reacting to a situation according to the patterns we developed as children. We "act out." Acting out is when we feel something like sadness or anger or happiness and either don't realize it, don't understand why, or won't allow ourselves to experience the feelings all the way. Instead they explode or leak out in other

ways. For instance, a child who is jealous of a new sibling is not usually allowed to feel that--instead they may stab the baby with crayons. Similarly, feelings of jealousy on the job may not be experienced, but acted out through backbiting or sabotage.

Emotional literacy is the ability to be self aware, to understand what we are feeling and finally to choose our behavior. With this self-awareness, we can behave in ways that produce specific, desired results in the workplace. Radical Choices methodologies specifically teach emotional literacy tools that help people to become conscious of their own experiences, feelings, and resistance to change so that they are not compelled to continue old behavioral patterns that unconsciously sabotage their relationships with managers, employees, customers, friends or family. It includes developing the skills to recognize the unspoken messages from others, so that individuals can align themselves and address real needs and issues. The direct results include the development of authentic, healthy relationships based upon trust and relevant information. These results can translate into motivated, empowered employees and loyal customers.

Radical Choices and Business Results

A disadvantage of not feeling everything is that we misinterpret what is going on. This is deadly in our relationships and our businesses. Someone we are dealing with may feel angry, and if we are not able to experience anger we may think he or she are sad or not notice, and then act on that faulty information. This kind of misinterpreting seriously damages business and personal relationships.

Knowing the emotional underpinning of the decisions that we make and the emotional content of interactions with our co-workers and clients can provide a new dimension of comprehension to almost every situation in the workplace. Radical Choices has over 30 years of teaching the technology of emotional literacy and its applications at work.

- Emotional Literacy includes developing the skills to recognize the unspoken messages from others, so that individuals can align themselves and address real needs and issues.



For example, a client's words may be about the cost being too much, but the real issue may be a lack of trust. Or, an associate may be acting angry but underneath, they are really just having a hard time with change.

> An Emotionally Literate person doesn't read something into an interaction or situation. An Emotionally Literate person knows what is truly going on. He or she won't respond to something happening now with a response from their history.

For example, if a manager behaves in a way that seems to be similar to a disrespectful manager from the past, they just notice that as information-but doesn't act on whatever feelings that resemblance engenders.

> Emotional Literacy teaches people to become conscious of their own experiences, feelings, and resistance to change, so that they can change old behavioral patterns rather than be compelled to continue them.

For example. If a firm is undergoing significant change, an emotionally literate person understands that cognitive dissonance (the discomfort caused when old beliefs are confronted with current reality) is part of the process of adapting to change and growing. Knowing this, a person is able to choose short-term discomfort for long-term behavioral change.

> An emotionally literate person is able to create Trusted Advisor relationships by listening to a clients' deepest needs and desires and respond in an authentic manner.

By applying this technology to our own organization and our clients, we have gained an understanding of how the brain works in relationship to emotions and behavior. This understanding led to the knowledge that people need not be controlled by emotional impulses, either conscience or unconscious, and that it is possible to make real choices about behaviors when there is a conscious awareness of emotions. Radical Choices has demonstrated to some of the

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America is a health game apparatus that enables persons having the same healthcommunities.

Kosmos Essay Draft v2 – Radical Choice (797 words)

There are different ways to live on our planet. We know it is possible to live an ordinary life that is integrated with an open heart and spirit. When Buckminster Fuller was asked how he described himself, he said, “I am an ordinary man.” We claim awareness of the potency of our choices. This is true more so now, at this precarious time on the planet. However, our research and personal experience shows that for the most part, many of us live in a significant gap between our stated values and our actions. This gap is the reason most of us do not make the most personally or globally beneficial choices in regards to health and wellbeing. We say we will. We make promises to others and ourselves. We don’t keep our word and feel badly about ourselves. We really want to make a different choice for ourselves and find it very difficult at times. What to do?! We believe we have a master key to open this door and make those changes we care about.

When we are born, we are openhearted– we laugh when we are happy, we cry when we need something. We move from one emotion to the other, and nothing is “stuck.” And during those first few years of life, as you all know, parents tell us “how to be.” And we adapt. We are told, “Do not say that,” “speak softer,” “you shouldn’t do this,” “you need to talk to me like this,” “I am your mother,” (blah, blah, blah, blah...) – and we do it. We do it, because we have to survive in our families. We do it because we are loyal and loving. We do it because we want to do the right thing. We do it because we are part of our family’s tribe.

That is called conditioning. Everybody has it. There is not one of us who does not; and, it is like being on a freight train that we cannot stop. We are entrained in our conditioning, so we're just doing what we were taught to do. We don't even think about it. And, if we do, it is usually an either/or situation. We are in reaction. Over time we believed our image of the world and ourselves and became blind to how we affected others. We certainly do not want to perpetuate and preserve old patterns that prevent us from experiencing our birthright of happiness.

Our choices are determined by our conditioning. We are all inexorably attached to our images and conditioned behavior. We know, when we respond to what is happening now in the same way we did when we were children, we feel restricted. That small voice that whispers STOP in our hearts and minds needs strengthening.

A Radical Choice is that intersection between what we were taught and life itself. That is where risks can be taken. We are truly safe knowing that we are not alone, that we are *not separate*. This can be a difficult concept for us although we have learned it and we understand it. There is an experience of knowing we are *not alone or separate*. This knowing is the result of integrity. This knowing needs no explanation. This knowing works every time.

To be whole requires seeing parts of ourselves we spent a lifetime denying, projecting on others, and pretending it does not exist. We try to prove our point to the exclusion of love and trust. We do this out of fear that we might not be loved, or we might not survive truly seeing ourselves, or we would be driven insane from revulsion at what we discover. That is not true. None of it is true. However, we need to experience that ourselves.

Disruptive Learning Technology (DLT) is a step-by-step practice that dissolves patterns while transforming our thoughts, feelings and behavior over time, when followed exactly as intended. No sugar when salt is asked for. It is a practice of precisely living our Six Principles of Insight, Personal Responsibility, Authenticity, Integrity, Clear Mind and Awakened Action.

DLT propels us to self-awareness. We see our experiences, our feelings, and our resistance to change. We are here and seeing

simultaneously. Our resistance is just pure energy that we use to transform history into awareness. We are no longer bound to continue behavior patterns that impair and degrade our relationships. When we have shaped and formed the muscle of self-awareness, we are able to change our conditioned wiring at the same time we are in reaction. Really!!! It is then and only then we have free choice and can choose a different trajectory right in the fire of reaction. The either/or disappears and an open field of possibilities appear.

We are all in the same tribe.

Real Impact learning and Emotional Literacy

Individuals all have a native emotional knowledge of the world. As children, we are usually aware our feelings. We are taught by our family which of these feelings are safe to share and which we need to put to the side. Because of this, we learn how to adapt to the world around us as needed.

(EL). Emotional Literacy is the ability and commitment to be self-aware, and as a result make decisions and behave in alignment with our objectives and vision. People who achieve this ability can accomplish business and personal relationship goals with ease and unimagined success. RIL teaches people to apply this intelligence to their everyday decisions and behaviors through RIL's Emotional Literacy Learning Process.

What Is Emotional Literacy?

There are many events that we want to leave behind so we cloud them up or we create pleasant illusions to cover up the pain. When we do this we then forget in our conscious minds what happened. When any experience is changed and the feelings are diluted and dulled, the particles don't go away. The particles build up and begin to control our behavior, albeit unconsciously. This can lead to disastrous results

We develop our patterns of side-stepping painful emotions, patterns of interpretation and protection, in our childhood. Because these patterns are developed during our childhood many of us have no idea what and when we're feeling, we are really reacting to a situation according to the patterns we developed as children. We "act out." Acting out is when we feel something like sadness or anger or happiness and either don't realize it, don't understand why, or won't allow ourselves to experience the feelings all the way. Instead they explode or leak out in other ways. For instance, a child who is jealous of a new sibling is not usually allowed to feel that--instead they may stab the baby with crayons, twist the baby's foot through the bars of the crib or burn their own dolls. Similarly, feelings of jealousy on the job may not be experienced, but acted out through backbiting or sabotage.

Emotional literacy is the ability to be self aware. With this self awareness, we can behave in ways that produce specific, desired results in the workplace. Emotional literacy specifically teaches tools for people to become conscious of their own experiences, feelings,

and resistance to change, so that they are not compelled to continue old behavioral patterns that unconsciously sabotage their relationships with managers, employees, customers, friends or family. It includes developing the skills to recognize the unspoken messages from others, so that individuals can align themselves and address real needs and issues. The direct results include the development of authentic, healthy relationships based upon trust and relevant information. These results can translate into motivated, empowered employees and loyal customers.

Real Impact Learning and Business Results

A disadvantage of not feeling everything is that we misinterpret what is going on with other people. This can be deadly in our relationships and damaging to our businesses. Someone we are dealing with may be acting angry, and if we are not able to experience anger we may think they are sad or not notice- and act on that faulty information. The results can range from hurt feelings to a lost contract or a business setback. For example, if we think our relationship with a client is positive, and we are not aware of our own feelings, we will most likely be unaware of our client's real needs. Then we become surprised when they leave. We don't understand why they left. We say things like "I didn't do anything wrong." This kind of misinterpreting seriously damages business and personal relationships.

People tend to base their behavior on how they do or don't feel, not what they want to achieve. Communication theory research states that all decisions have an emotional component. Many organizations appear to be making decisions from a rational perspective, but when in fact examined more closely the decisions are based in avoiding pain and fear. When decisions are made from avoiding pain and fear, situations are created that result in things like:

- Missing a client's real needs and therefore the full potential of a sale
- Losing creative/trained people to other organizations
- Losing clients due to lack of trust and confidence
- Wasted time and duplicated effort

Knowing the emotional underpinning of the decisions that we make and the emotional content of interactions with our co-workers and clients can provide a new dimension of comprehension to almost every situation in the workplace. Orloff Consulting has spent over 20 years teaching the technology of emotional literacy and its applications at work.

1. Emotional Literacy includes developing the skills to recognize the unspoken messages from others, so that individuals can align themselves and address real needs and issues.
2. *For example, a client's words may be about the cost being too much, but the real issue may be a lack of trust. Or, an associate may be acting angry but underneath, they are really just having a hard time with change.*
3. An Emotionally Literate person doesn't read something into an